Diana Torres

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Profile

Economist and Master's student in Development Engineering at UC Berkeley with professional experience in public policy across multiple ministries. Experienced in translating rigorous evidence to inform policy decisions, redesigning programs for scalability, and navigating institutional dynamics to secure adoption. Skilled in evidence synthesis, stakeholder engagement, and adapting proven models to new contexts.

Education

University of California, Berkeley — Berkeley, CA
Master of Development Engineering — Expected Dec 2026
Relevant Coursework: Design Evaluate & Scale Development Technologies, Critical Systems of Development

National University of San Marcos — Lima, Peru
Bachelor's Degree in Economics — Apr 2011 – Dec 2015
Graduated with distinction (Top ∼1% of class)

Experience

Innovations for Poverty Action (IPA) — Lima, Peru
Senior Policy Associate — Apr 2022 – Aug 2025

- Redesigned and adapted multiple evidence-based interventions for Peru's Ministry of Vulnerable Populations, including a major program inspired by the BRAC ELA model—by integrating RCT findings, qualitative and quantitativa data, and implementation constraints.
- Developed learning agendas to guide decision-making and supported the Ministry in securing multi-institutional funding for the revised models' next phase.
- Conducted literature reviews to identify core mechanisms of impact and inform evidence-based policy recommendations for government ministries.
- Led the scale-up of evidence-based education programs with the Ministry of Education, building partnerships with local foundations and Enseña Perú to enable regional adoption and long-term sustainability.

Office of the Comptroller General of the Republic — Lima, Peru
Specialist in Impact Evaluations — Mar 2024 – Jun 2024

- Worked with audit teams to design quasi-experimental evaluations of audit interventions applied to health and public safety programs, translating findings into recommendations that informed oversight and accountability decisions.

International Labour Organization (ILO) — Lima, Peru
Consultant — Apr 2024 – Aug 2024

- Co-authored analysis on monopsony power and labor market trends for *World Employment and Social Outlook 2025*; produced indicators in R and Stata to support findings.

Ministry of Foreign Trade and Tourism — Lima, Peru
Tourism and Crafts Research Analyst — Jun 2019 – Apr 2021; Jan 2022 – Apr 2022

- Consolidated dispersed data into integrated datasets to improve sector diagnostics and decision-making.
- Built a tourism intelligence system enabling faster access to indicators and clearer diagnostics for officials.
- Led data-quality dialogues with regional offices to streamline information flows.

Ministry of Education Lima, Peru
Regional Sector Specialist (Planning & Budget) May 2021 – Dec 2021
- Worked with planning and budget teams to monitor regional education interventions, using Power BI dashboards to support implementation follow-up.
- Facilitated an inter-agency agreement securing >$200K to continue an early childhood education project.

Publications & Presentations

Publication
Contributing Author, *World Employment and Social Outlook: Trends 2025.* International Labour Organization (2025). DOI: 10.54394/IZLN1673

Conference Talks
Labour Market Frictions, Trade and Informality: Evidence from Peru. Eastern Economic Association (New York, 2024); Bolivian Conference on Development Economics (2021); Western Economic Association, 100th Annual (California, 2025).

Leadership & Activities

La Molina Agrarian University — Rural Accompaniment by Broadcasting Lima, Peru
Program Lead (Volunteer) Mar 2022 – Sep 2022
- Led radio programming for farmers on crop improvement, agroecology, and commercialization.

Young Professionals for Agricultural Development (FAO) Lima, Peru
M&E Lead, Rural Youth School (Volunteer) May 2021 – Oct 2021
- Monitored performance and improved research proposal quality.

TECHO Peru — Social Research Team Lima, Peru
Volunteer Jan 2017 – Jun 2019
- Contributed to first analysis of 138 human settlements in a highly vulnerable district of Lima.

Honors & Certifications

Honors
Learning Days of Evidence in Governance and Politics (Scholarship, Mexico, 2024); 2nd Place, National Essay "Youth Vision on Peru's Integration into APEC" (2021); 1st Place, National Academic Essay, Superintendence of Securities Market (2015); Top-5 Finalist, CIDEPRO Finance Case Competition (2013).

Certifications
Macroeconometrics & Microeconometrics; Evaluating Social Programs (MIT); Multidimensional Poverty (OPHI); R Specialization; Sub-National Competitiveness Indicators (CENTRUM PUCP–OAS); Labor Market & Social Protection in LAC (UBA); Labor Market, Poverty & Inequality in LAC (UNLP).

Skills & Interests

Technical: R, Stata, Python, Power BI
Analytical and strategic: Evidence synthesis, program redesign, scaling strategies, decision-support materials.
Languages: Spanish (Native), English (Advanced)
Interests: Evidence-to-policy translation, data-for-development, social innovation, technology for social impact.